

Collection delay and cash timing

Synthetic research note / Four-period operating cash bridge

SYNTHETIC TEST DATA - internal output-format demonstration

Finding

With billings and cash costs held constant, longer collection delays deepen the temporary cash trough. In this artificial four-period example, the two-period delay creates a 45 SCU gap beyond the assumed 75 SCU buffer. The numbers demonstrate timing arithmetic only.

The result is conditional on the input fixture. It does not establish a customer, market, revenue-recognition rule, financing source, accounting basis, tax treatment or rollout decision.

Scenario comparison

Scenario	Lag	Billings	Cash trough	Need	Gap	Ending AR
No lag	0	400	0	0	0	0
One-period lag	1	400	-60	60	0	100
Two-period lag	2	400	-120	120	45	200

1 SCU is a synthetic cash unit. Ending receivables equal total fixture billings less receipts within the four periods; this is not an accounting receivables balance.

Buffer gap by collection delay

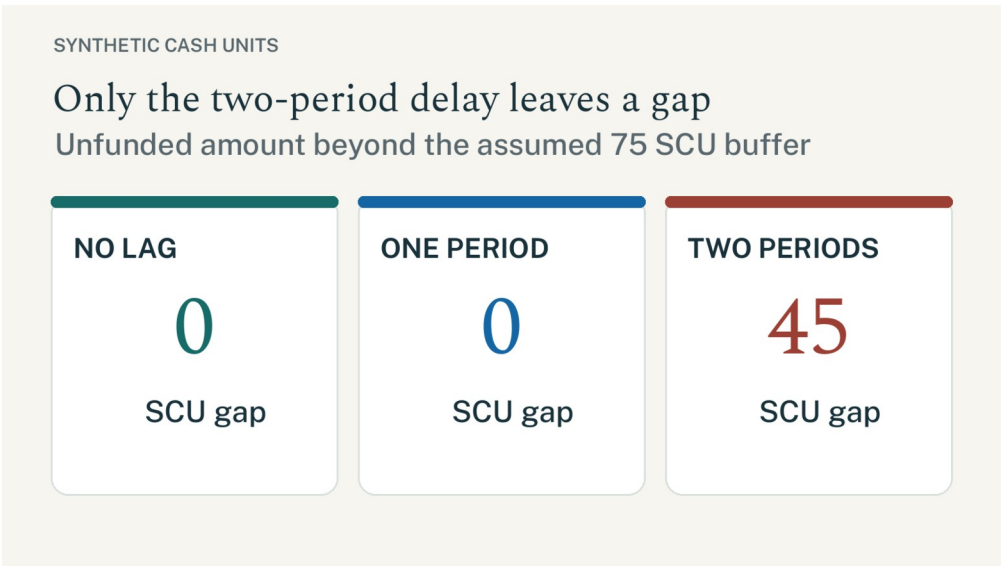


Figure 1. Only the two-period delay leaves a gap beyond the assumed buffer.
Source: P13-SYNTHETIC-CASH-TIMING-FIXTURE (synthetic fixture; 2026-09-27).

Reperformance detail

The next table is intentionally long enough to exercise row continuity and repeated headers across a page boundary. Every value traces to the one synthetic fixture; calculations are reproduced in the editable workbook.

Scenario	Period	Billings	Receipts	Cash costs	Closing cash
No lag	1	100	100	60	40
No lag	2	100	100	60	80
No lag	3	100	100	60	120
No lag	4	100	100	60	160
One-period lag	1	100	0	60	-60
One-period lag	2	100	100	60	-20
One-period lag	3	100	100	60	20
One-period lag	4	100	100	60	60
Two-period lag	1	100	0	60	-60
Two-period lag	2	100	0	60	-120
Two-period lag	3	100	100	60	-80
Two-period lag	4	100	100	60	-40

Source: synthetic fixture only. No source transaction, accounting period or report balance is represented.

Inputs and interpretation

Item	Value	Interpretation / limit
Billings / cash costs	100 / 60 SCU per period	Artificial inputs; held constant across all scenarios.
Opening cash / buffer	0 / 75 SCU	The buffer is assumed; it is not committed funding.
Horizon / collection	4 periods / 100%	Simplifying test assumptions; credit risk is not modelled.
Reporting framework	Not selected	No entity-specific financial statements are produced.
Revenue / tax	NOT ASSESSED	No recognition, tax rate or statutory treatment is included.
Source / date	P13-SYNTHETIC-CASH-TIMING-FIXTURE / 2026-09-27	Synthetic fixture; date is not an effective date for law or policy.
Reconciliation / approval	Arithmetic only / none	No subledger, control account, report, Controller or tax sign-off was supplied.
Translation / portability	French sample / local PDF	Translation review, font embedding and recipient-machine proof remain NOT ASSESSED.

Bilingual disclosure sample

Illustrative scenario only; these figures do not describe a customer or forecast.

Scénario illustratif uniquement ; ces chiffres ne décrivent pas un client ni une prévision. (French layout sample; translation not reviewed.)

Countercase and next evidence

A longer delay matters only if the inputs and decision horizon are representative. The same gap can disappear with opening liquidity, lower costs, partial collections or a different horizon. None of those alternatives was tested here.

Before a real decision, obtain an approved transaction and reporting scope, trace source-event timing, confirm available funding, and have the accountable finance reviewer reperform the calculation. Do not convert this example into a forecast or funding recommendation.